Minutes of the Meeting of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax Held Electronically on Monday, March 22, 2021 at 7:00 p.m.

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca *or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347*

Present:	Mayor	S. Collier
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		A. Khan
		L. Bower

1. Call to Order & Land Acknowledgement

Mayor Collier called the meeting to order at 7:00 p.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interest.

3. Adoption of the Minutes

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That the minutes of the Regular Meeting of Council held on February 22, 2021 be adopted.
CARRIED

4. Question Period

Mayor Collier noted that members of the public were advised they could submit questions regarding the agenda to the Town Clerk up until noon on the day of the meeting. Alexander Harras, Manager of Legislative Services/Deputy Clerk, noted that no questions had been received regarding the contents of the meeting agenda.

5. Delegations and Presentations

5.1 Presentation: Ajax Anti-Black Racism (AABR) Task Force Update

Mariska Thomas, Chair, and Dane Lawrence, Vice-Chair, AABR Task Force, provided an update from the AABR Task Force. M. Thomas and D. Lawrence discussed the United Nations International Decade for People of African Descent, identifying the 3 main pillars as recognition, justice and development. M. Thomas and D. Lawrence discussed recommendations, paid internships, establishing a Black owned businesses directory, and implementation of a speaker series to educate the public. M. Thomas and D. Lawrence concluded their presentation highlighting AABR Task Force initiatives completed to date.

Council Members asked questions regarding opportunities for representation and support from the AABR Task Force at the Town of Ajax Economic Development Roundtable committee, and examples of paid internship programs amongst other municipalities. D. Lawrence responded to questions from Council Members.

On behalf of Council, Mayor Collier thanked M. Thomas and D. Lawrence for their presentation.

5.2 **Presentation: PARA Marine Search & Rescue: 2021 Community, Government & Corporate Awareness**

Colin Thomson, Commodore, PARA Marine Search & Rescue, delivered a presentation regarding PARA Marine Search & Rescue: 2021 Community, Government & Corporate Awareness. C. Thomson discussed services provided, 2021 – 2025 Strategic & Business Plan, management transparency, Search and Rescue (SAR) readiness, 2020 Durham Region report highlights, tasking locations, community awareness, branding, asset management for vessel replacement with near shore capability, and financial strength and sustainability.

Council Members asked questions regarding marine safety, awareness and education. C. Thomson responded to questions from Council Members.

On behalf of Council, Mayor Collier thanked C. Thomson for the presentation.

5.3 **Presentation: Economic Development Action Plan**

Lauren Millier, MDB Insights, delivered a presentation regarding the 2021 to 2025 Town of Ajax Economic Development Action Plan (EDAP). L. Millier acknowledged contributions from the EDAP project team and reviewed the EDAP development process, action plan goals and actions, cross department interaction, COVID-19 economic recovery, Town of Ajax BIAs, COVID-specific action items, rollout, and next steps.

Council Members asked questions regarding status of the Competitive Ready certification, comprehensive review plans for the Town's two BIAs, walkable and pedestrian-first development, Pickering Village intensification, development and attractions, and anticipated timelines to recruit and promote the Economic Development Roundtable committee. L. Millier, Geoff Romanowski, Director of Planning & Development Services, and Don Terry, Interim Manager of Economic Development, responded to questions from Council Members.

On behalf of Council, Mayor Collier thanked L. Millier for her presentation.

6. Correspondence

Motion to Suspend the Rules of Procedure

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: A. Khan

That the Rules of Procedure be suspended in order to add an item of correspondence from Ontario's Big City Mayors regarding their March 19th meeting.

CARRIED
on 2/3rds

Members separated correspondence items 6.9 and 6.17.

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: J. Dies

That the balance of the report (Items 6.1, 6.2, 6.3, 6.4, 6.5, 6.6, 6.7, 6.8, 6.10, 6.11, 6.12, 6.13, 6.14, 6.15 and 6.16) dated March 22, 2021 containing Items of Correspondence be received for information.

CARRIED

Item 6.9

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: S. Lee

That Item 6.9 ("Township of Brock – Request for an Interim Cap on Gas Plant and Greenhouse Gas Pollution and the Development and Implementation of a Plan to Phase-Out-Gas-Fire Electricity Generation") of the Correspondence Report be endorsed.

CARRIED

Item 6.17

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That Item 6.17 ("Ontario's Big City Mayors – COVID Business Restrictions") of the Correspondence Report be endorsed.

CARRIED

7. Reports

7.1 Community Affairs & Planning Report

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: A. Khan

That the Community Affairs & Planning Report dated March 1, 2021, be adopted.

CARRIED

7.2 General Government Committee Report

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the General Government Committee Report dated March 8, 2021, be adopted.

CARRIED

7.3 Summary of Advisory Committee Activities

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: A. Khan

That the Summary of Advisory Committee Activities Report dated March 22, 2021, as attached to the meeting agenda be received for information, and that the recommendations contained therein be referred to staff where applicable.

CARRIED

7.4 Departmental Reports

7.4.1 PDS-2021-09: Economic Development Action Plan

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: A. Khan

That the Town of Ajax 5-Year (2021-2025) Economic Development Action Plan be endorsed.

CARRIED

8. Regional Councillors' Report

Regional Councillor Crawford provided an update regarding Vision Zero accessible pedestrian signal (APS) devices, red lights cameras, and automated speed enforcement.

Mayor Collier provided an updated regarding COVID-19 vaccination clinics. Mayor Collier noted that Audley Recreation Centre (1955 Audley Road North, Ajax) will open on March 24, 2021 with transportation services available via Durham Region Transit on Demand Service during clinic hours.

Mayor Collier noted that Regional Council approved the 1.9% tax increase at the previous Regional Council meeting.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That the Regional Councillors' Reports of March 22, 2021 be received for information.

CARRIED

9. Business Arising from Notice of Motion

9.1 Land Banking Levy

Mayor Collier vacated the Chair. Deputy Mayor Dies assumed the Chair.

Mayor Collier and Regional Councillor Lee introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: S. Lee

WHEREAS the Town of Ajax is rapidly growing but constrained by a fixed urban boundary and limited greenfield remaining for new development;

AND WHEREAS employment and economic development are a primary focus of Council's mandate for the 2018-2022 term, laying the groundwork for long-term, sustainable growth toward a community vision supported by appropriate transportation, housing and employment options for residents;

AND WHEREAS some landowners hold on to employment lands over the medium or long-term without plans for development, in order to benefit from increasing land values (known as the practice of land banking);

AND WHEREAS land banking does not assist Council in achieving the best outcomes for Ajax, and action is necessary in order to encourage landowners to work with Planning and Development staff and Council to plan strategic, appropriate development to the 2051 horizon achieving densities and intensification as required under the Places to Grow Act;

THEREFORE BE IT NOW RESOLVED THAT:
Staff be directed to investigate a land banking levy and report back financial, legal and strategic implications of a land banking levy program and recommendations for consideration prior to the 2022 budget process.

CARRIED

9.2 Hunt Street to Westney Road Extension

Mayor Collier and Councillor Bower introduced the motion and reviewed its contents. Mayor Collier and G. Romanowski responded to questions on the motion from Council Members.

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: L. Bower

WHEREAS Ajax Council believes in sustainable growth, following principles of intensification and density outlined in A Place to Grow: Growth Plan for the Greater Golden Horseshoe, 2020, in strategic growth areas including Downtown Ajax;

AND WHEREAS the Town's downtown area will exceed growth targets, reaching growth numbers in line with GTHA urban growth centres - even without a formal designation - based on applications currently under review alone, helping the Region of Durham grow in a sustainable and transit-supportive way, up to and beyond the 2051 planning horizon;

AND WHEREAS a lack of sanitary capacity in our downtown core is the largest barrier to development for the Town of Ajax. This barrier was identified to Council early in the 2018-2022 term, and has been a central focus of Council's transportation, growth, and connectivity planning (through the Central Ajax Intensification, Servicing and Transportation Study currently underway) and advocacy (this issue has been flagged for five provincial Ministers, as well as the Region of Durham);

AND WHEREAS the Town's Transportation Master Plan identified the need for an extension of Hunt Street to Westney Road to support increased transportation connectivity and alleviate servicing constraints in the downtown area, and an environmental assessment and preliminary design for the extension were completed in 2016;

AND WHEREAS 285-289 Hunt St. and 232-234 MacKenzie Avenue (totaling 22.95 acres) have recently been listed for sale, which may present an opportunity for the Town to acquire these lands to advance and prepare for the critical Hunt Street extension;

THEREFORE BE IT NOW RESOLVED THAT:

Economic Development staff, in consultation with Transportation, Planning, and Finance, be directed to report back to the May 2021 General Government Committee meeting with a report assessing the scope of property acquisitions required to facilitate the extension of Hunt Street to Westney Road, including the acquisition of 285-289 Hunt St. and 232-234 Mackenzie Avenue, which are currently on the market for sale.

CARRIED

9.3 **Hiring Practices**

Regional Councillor Lee and Mayor Collier introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: S. Collier

WHEREAS best practices in the field of Human Resources (HR) and specifically in hiring processes are continually evolving;

AND WHEREAS the Town has onboarded a new Manager of HR Services and several other expert HR staff in this term of Council;

AND WHEREAS several examples of racism and racial injustice throughout 2020 shone a light on institutional and systemic biases, and the need to actively re-evaluate processes to uncover and eliminate built-in bias;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT HR Services staff be directed to present an update at the May 2021 meeting of Council on process improvements and upcoming initiatives as they relate to the Town's commitment to inclusive hiring practices.

CARRIED

With the consent of Members present, item 9.5 was advanced in the order business.

9.5 **Proposed changes to Minister's zoning orders and the Planning Act (Bill 257, Schedule 3)**

Mayor Collier and Regional Councillor Crawford introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: M. Crawford

WHEREAS Ajax Council believes in smart, sustainable development that is directed away from and protects natural heritage features and their functions;

AND WHEREAS the Town makes land use planning and development decisions that encourage complete communities and that protect the natural environment consistent with the Provincial Policy Statement (PPS), and in conformity with the Greenbelt Plan and Place to Grow: Growth Plan for the Greater Golden Horseshoe;

AND WHEREAS the PPS is a consolidated statement of the province's policies on land use planning and development that provides for appropriate development while protecting resources of provincial interest, public health and safety, and the quality of the natural and built environment;

AND WHEREAS section 3(5) of the Planning Act requires municipal and provincial decisions to be consistent with the PPS;

AND WHEREAS Schedule 3 of Bill 257 (Supporting Broadband and Infrastructure Expansion Act, 2021) would remove the requirement for a Minister's Zoning Order to be consistent with the PPS; reducing the efficacy of the PPS and overall contradicting the intent and principles of the Planning Act and PPS;

AND WHEREAS the provincial government is seeking comments on the proposed changes to Minister's Zoning Orders in the Planning Act (Bill 257, Schedule 3) until April 3 through ERO posting #019-3233;

THEREFORE BE IT NOW RESOLVED THAT:

1. Ajax Council believes the province should maintain its commitment to land use planning for the long-term benefit of Ontario by upholding its own policies and priorities

in all land use decisions; and that all land use planning decisions - provincial and municipal - should remain consistent with the Provincial Policy Statement;

2. Council strongly urges the province to repeal Schedule 3 of Bill 257 (Supporting Broadband and Infrastructure Expansion Act, 2021); and

3. This motion be submitted as the Town's official comments through ERO posting #019-3233, and distributed to Premier Doug Ford, Hon. Steve Clark, Minister of Municipal Affairs and Housing, MPP Rod Phillips, the Ontario Big City Mayors Caucus and the Region of Durham.

CARRIED

Mayor Collier resumed the Chair.

9.4 **Growing the Greenbelt**

Regional Councillor Dies and Councillor Bower introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: L. Bower

WHEREAS the Greenbelt is an integral component of land use planning across the Greater Golden Horseshoe and in Durham Region, encouraging smart growth and protecting key natural heritage and hydrological features and areas, and agricultural lands;

AND WHEREAS the Town has been and continues to be a supporter and champion of the Greenbelt, to improve the quality of life for the residents of Ajax, Durham Region and the Greater Toronto Area;

AND WHEREAS the Toronto and Region Conservation Authority (TRCA) has used a science-based approach to study the watersheds in west Durham, identifying key natural heritage and hydrological features, and have a solid scientific understanding about the current and future health of these watersheds;

AND WHEREAS the Province of Ontario released posting ERO #019-3136 on the Environmental Registry of Ontario seeking feedback on growing the size and enhancing the quality of the Greenbelt;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT:

1. The Town commends the province for exploring options to increase the size and quality of the Greenbelt;

2. The Town requests that the on-the-ground knowledge and scientific understanding of conservation authorities be leveraged by the province in order to make the best science-informed decisions and remove political bias regarding what lands should be protected by the Greenbelt;

3. Staff be directed to submit comments on the following matters through ERO #019-3136 by the submission deadline:

    - the addition of the headwaters of the Carruthers Creek ('whitebelt' lands in northeast Pickering) into the Greenbelt;
    - the expansion of the Urban River Valley designation (including Duffins and Carruthers Creeks in Ajax) to include lands studied through a science-based approach for appropriate Environmental Protection;

4. A copy of this resolution be forwarded to Hon. Doug Ford, Premier of Ontario, Steve Clark, Minister of Municipal Affairs and Housing, Rod Phillips, Ajax MPP, Environmental Defence, Friends of the Greenbelt Foundation, Region of Durham, TRCA and local Durham Region municipalities.

CARRIED

10. By-laws

There were no by-laws on the agenda.

11. Notice of Motion

Regional Councillor Lee indicated that he and Regional Councillor Dies will be bringing forward a motion regarding emission targets to the April meeting of Council.

12. New Business - Notices & Announcements

Council Members highlighted upcoming events and activities including a community Ward 1 meeting on March 29, 2021, a community Ward 2 meeting on March 23, 2021, and a Public Open House for a Zoning By-law Amendment regarding the property at Shoal Point Road and Bayly Street on March 30, 2021.

13. Confirming By-Law

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: L. Bower

That By-law number 19-2021 being a by-law to confirm the proceedings of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax at its meeting held on March 22, 2021 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

14. Adjournment

Moved by: A. Khan
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That the March 22, 2021 meeting of the Council of the Town of Ajax be adjourned (8:53 p.m.)

CARRIED

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Mayor

_____
D-Clerk